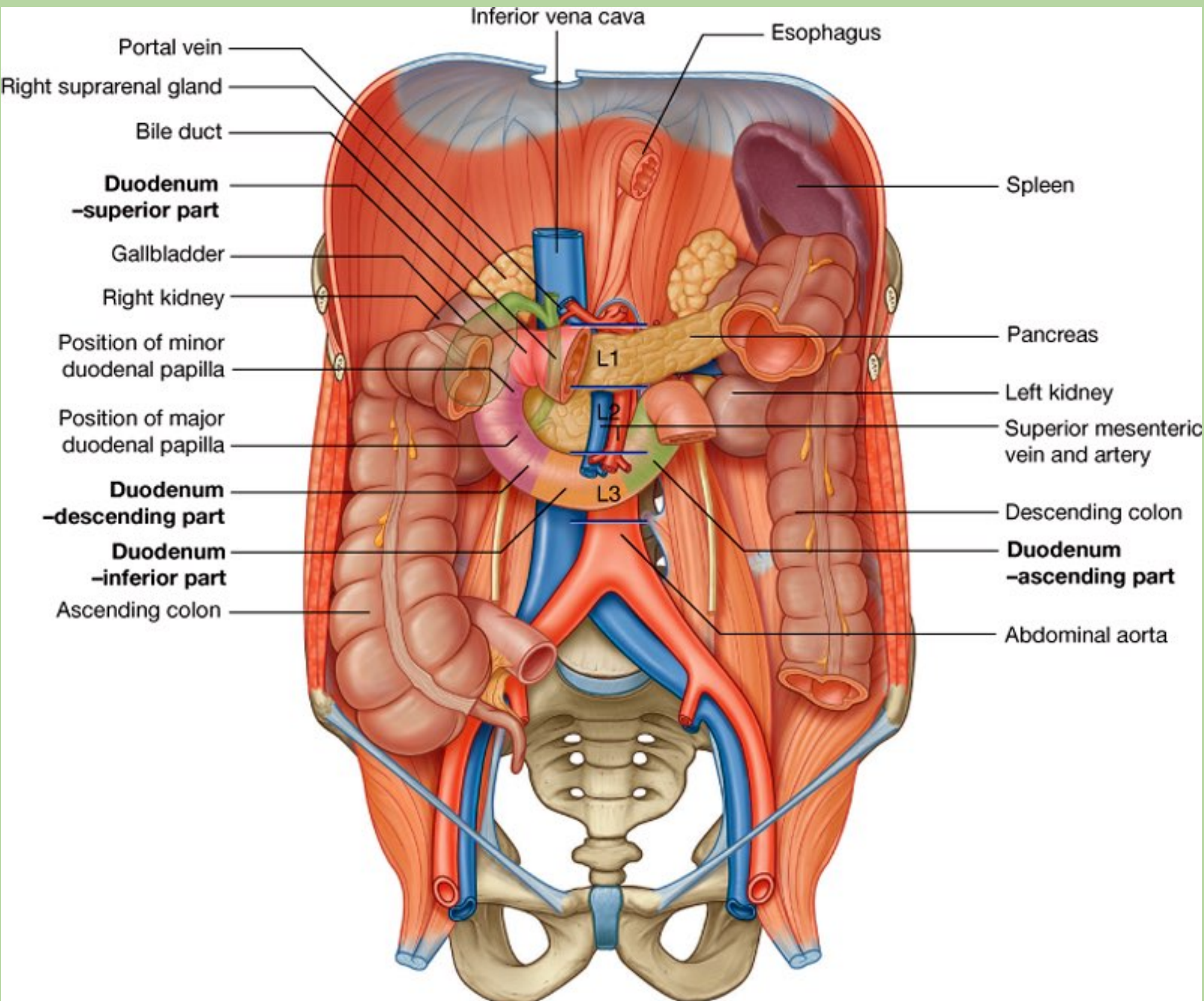


Duodenum

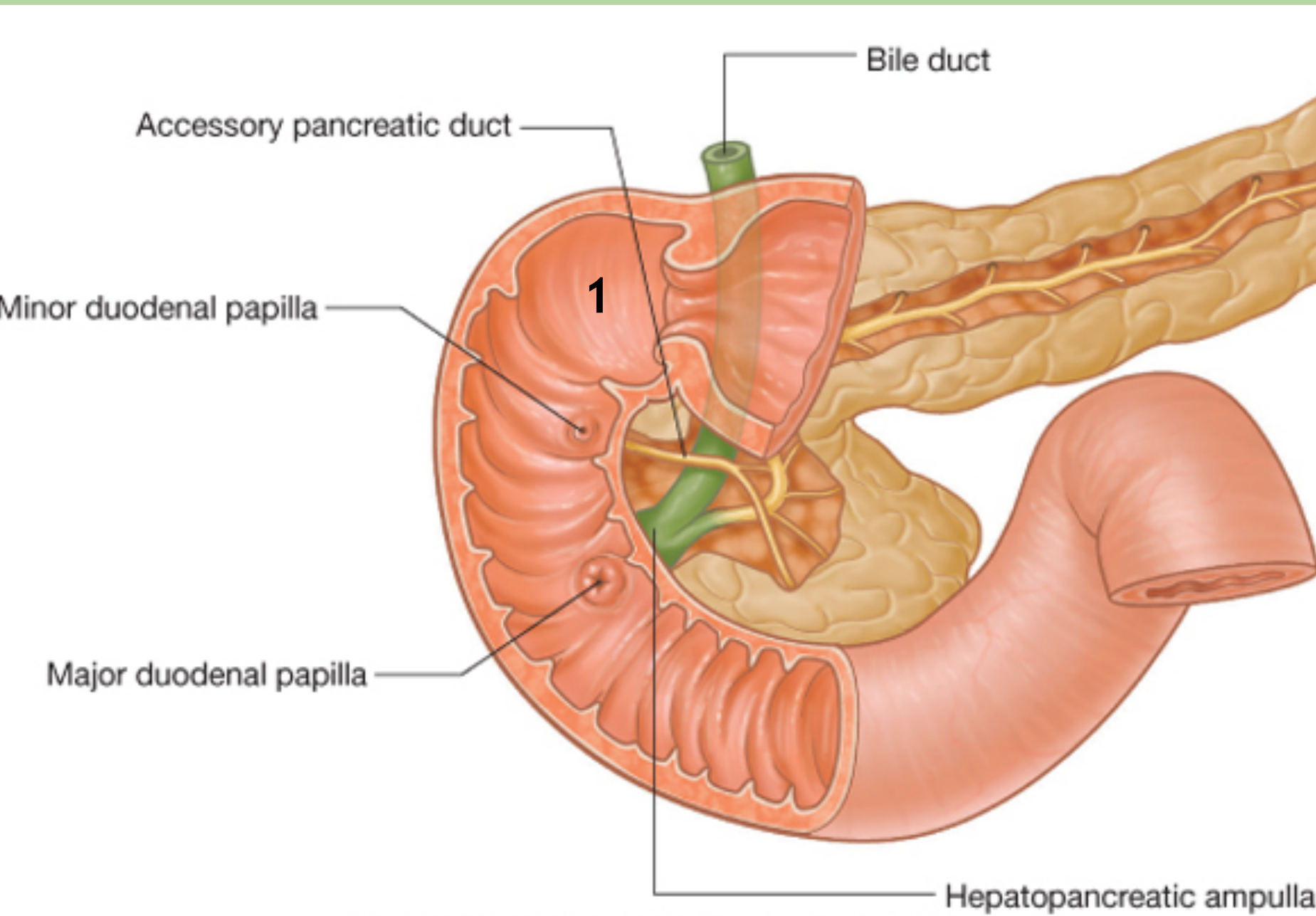


- approx. length: 25-30 cm
- vertebral levels: L1-3
- C-shaped curve around the head of the pancreas

• Parts:

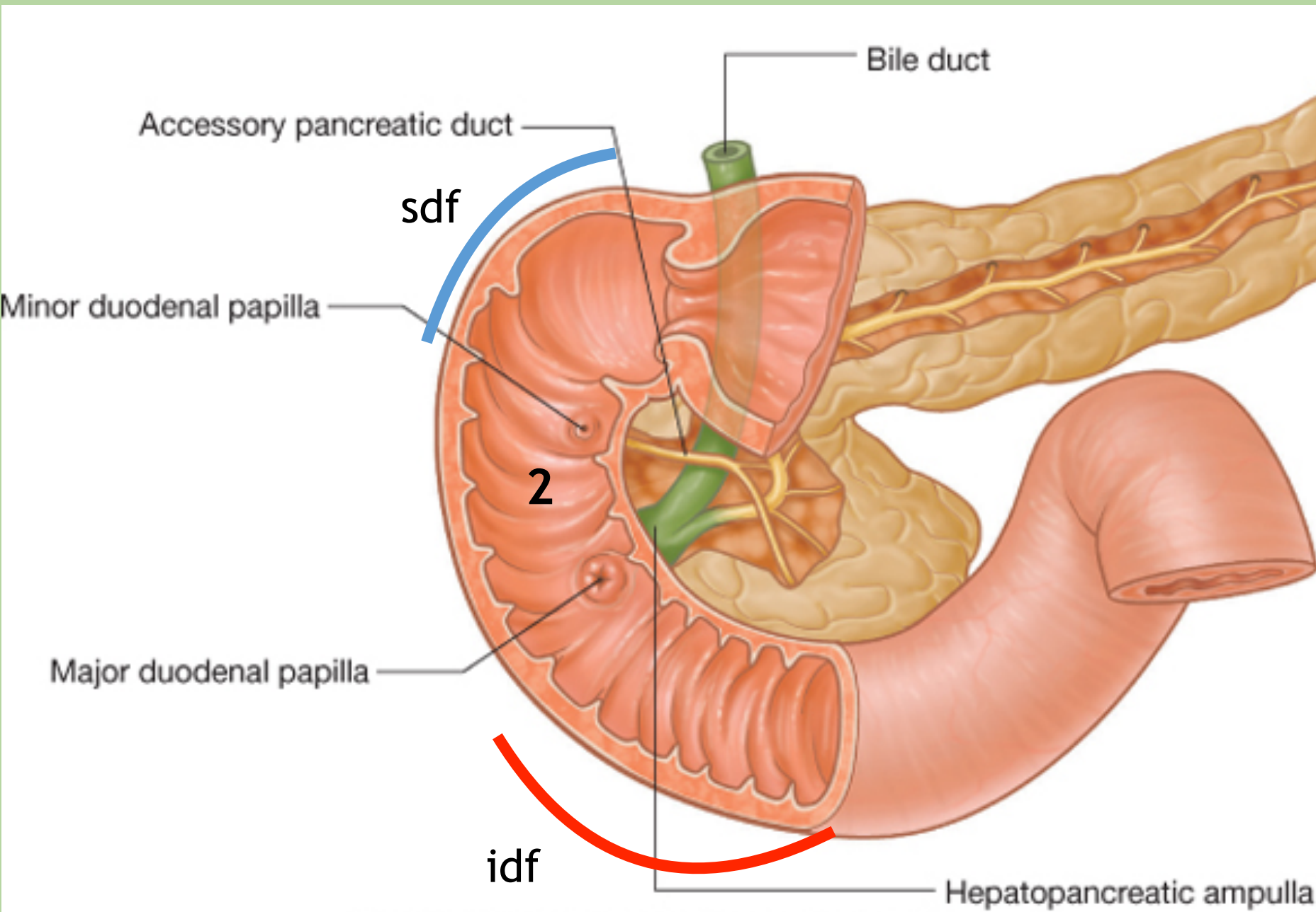
- 1: superior part
- 2: descending part
- 3: inferior (horizontal) part
- 4: ascending part

Duodenum: superior part (1)



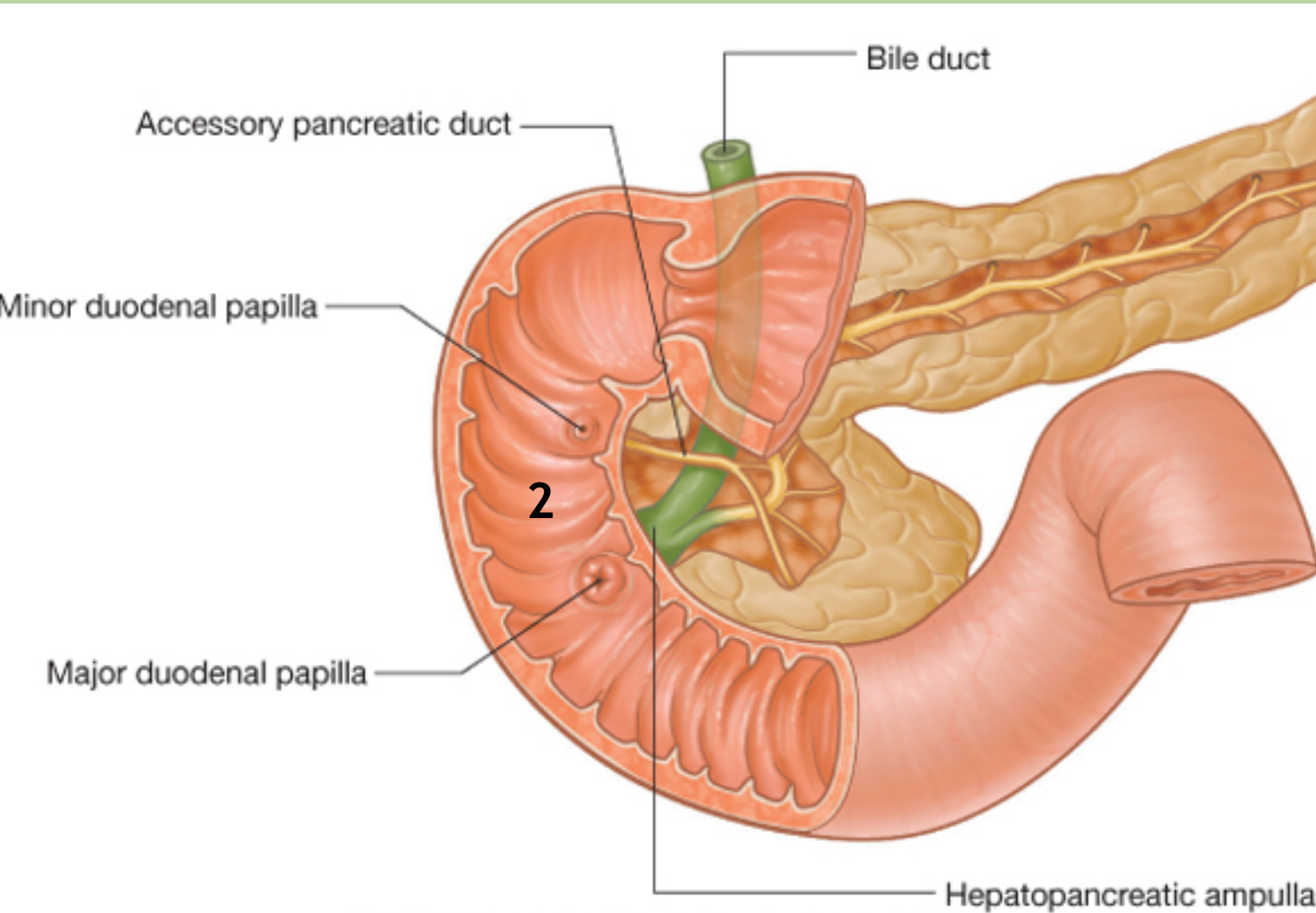
- L1 level
- *hepatoduodenal ligament attaches to its upper surface*
- **intraperitoneal structure**
- wide proximal lumen: *ampulla (=duodenal bulb)*

Duodenum: descending part (2)



- under the superior duodenal flexure (sdf) to the inferior duodenal flexure (idf)
- L1-3 levels
- **s e c o n d a r i l y**
r e t r o p e r i t o n e a l
s t r u c t u r e
- c i r c u l a r a n d
longitudinal mucosal folds
- *minor duodenal papilla*
- *major duodenal papilla*
(=Vater's papilla)

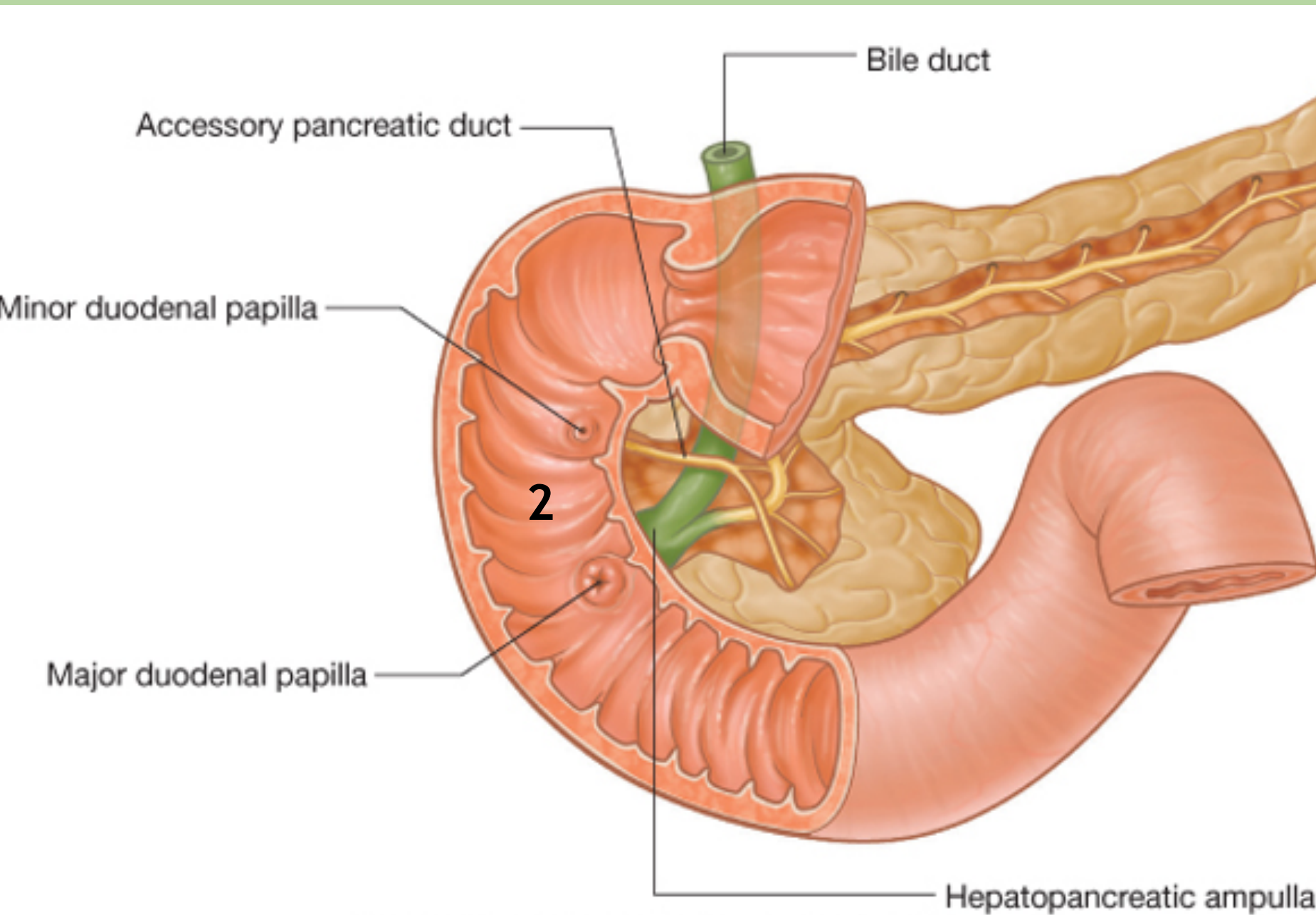
Duodenum: descending part (2)



Major duodenal papilla (=Vater's papilla):

- it locates 10 cm inferior to the pylorus
- the *hepatopancreatic ampulla*, formed by the *common bile duct and the major pancreatic duct* (=Wirsung's duct), enters the duodenum through the Vater's papilla on the postero-medial wall
- Oddi sphincter muscle lets the juices (bile and pancreatic juice) enter the duodenum

Duodenum: descending part (2)



- the accessory pancreatic duct (Santorini's duct) enters through the **minor duodenal papilla**
- it is presented in the 70% of the population (*in the 30%, the accessory pancreatic duct empties into the major pancreatic duct*)

Accessory pancreatic duct



Hepatopancreatic
ampulla, deep

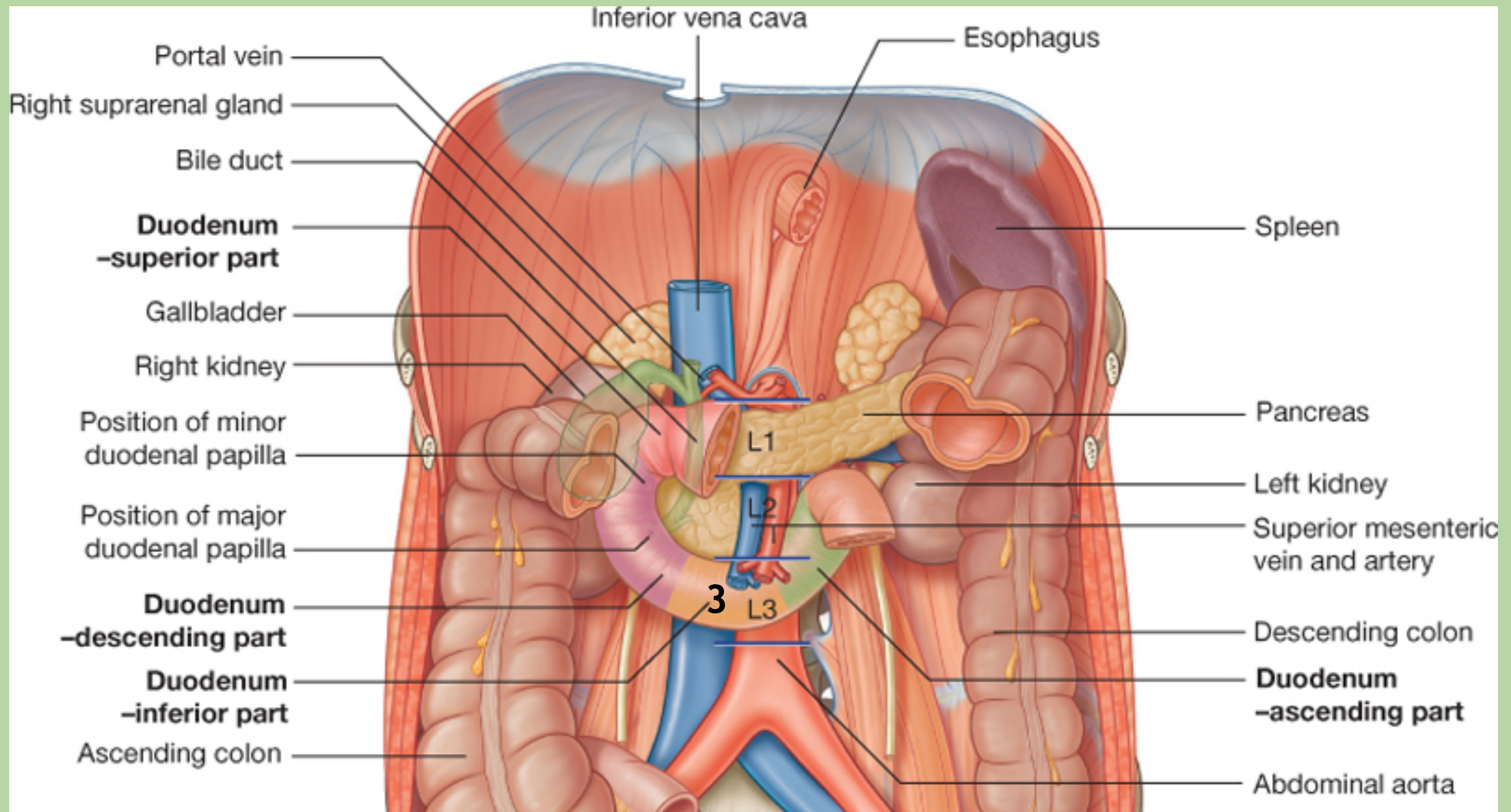
Major pancreatic duct

Abdominal cavity, anterior

BlueLink

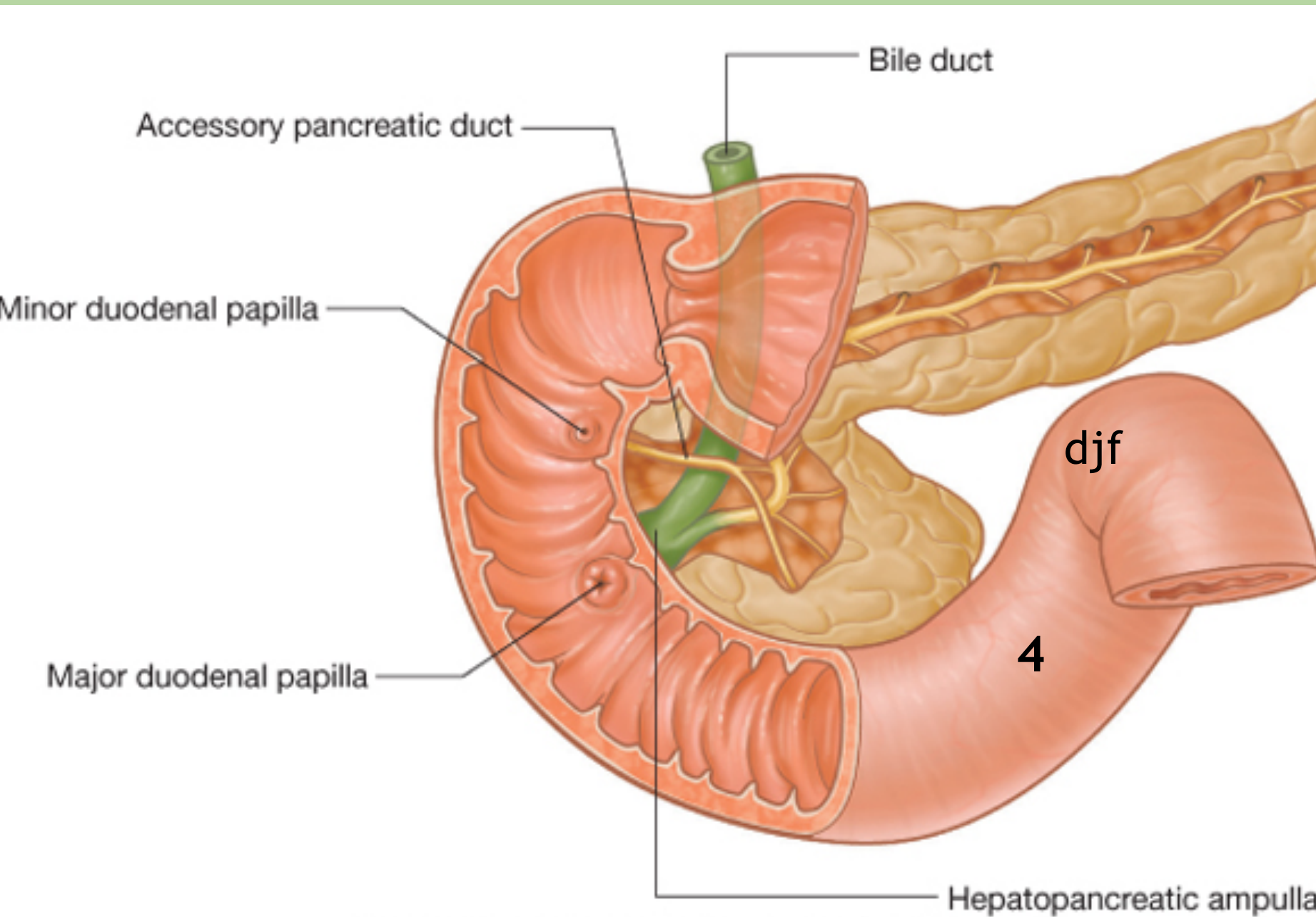
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Duodenum: inferior (horizontal) part (3)



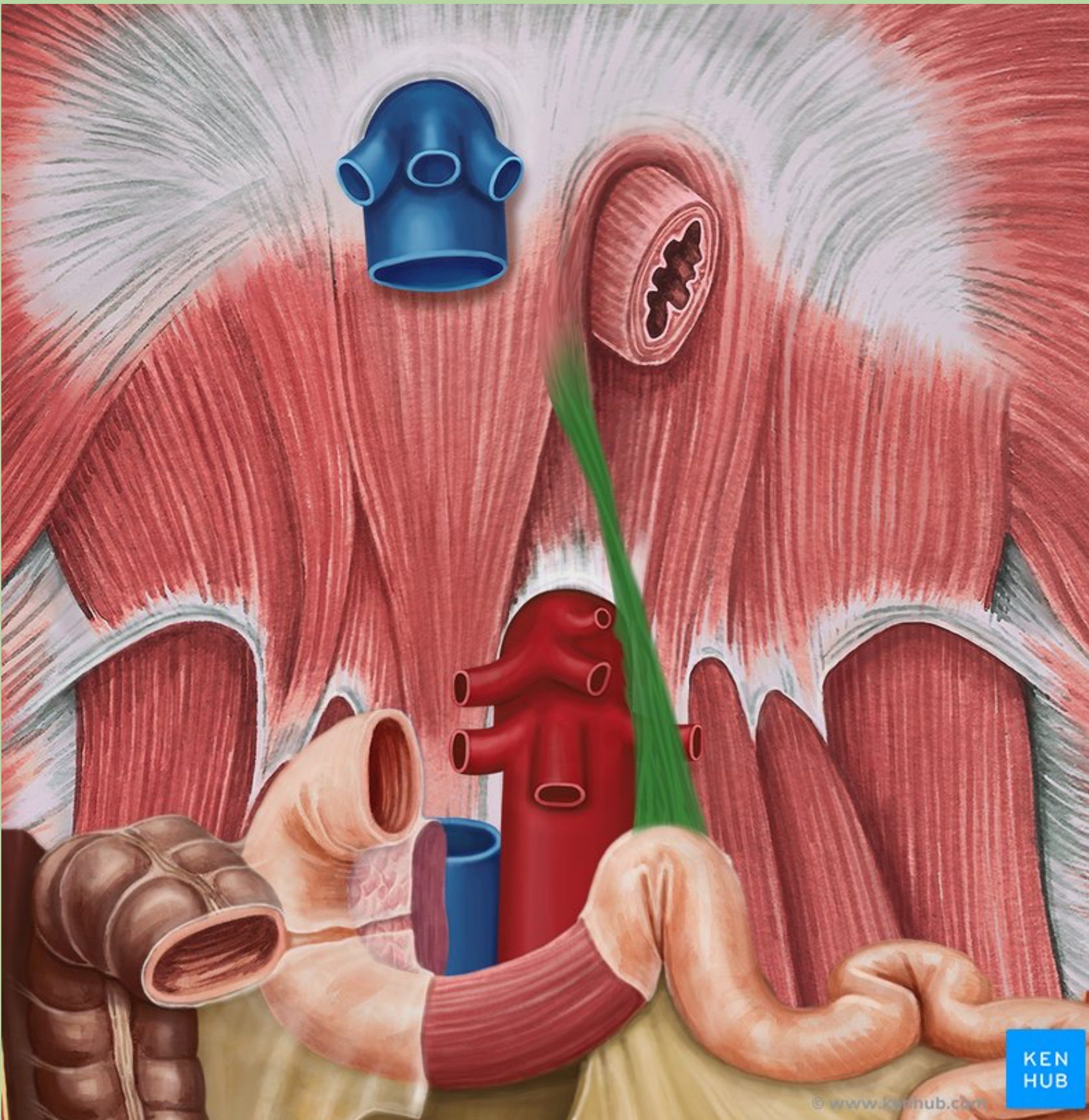
- L3 level
- **secondarily retroperitoneal structure**
- circular mucosal folds
- location: in front of the inferior vena cava and aorta; behind the superior mesenteric vessels

Duodenum: ascending part (4)



- L2 level
- **secondarily retroperitoneal**
- circular mucosal folds
- ends at the *duodenojejunal flexure (djf)*

Treitz's ligament (suspensory ligament of duodenum)



- peritoneal ligament which spans between the right diaphragmatic crus and duodenojejunal flexure
- *important landmark for discriminating between upper and lower gastrointestinal bleeding*
- *Treitz's herniation: small intestinal loops can get behind the ligament, causing obstruction or strangulation of the intestinal vessels*